SOCIAL EAGLE
learn. build. operate

WEEK 3 · DAY 5

Print the Top 5 Headlines from a News Site

Assignment | learn. build. operate

1. Problem Statement

Write a small **Python script** that opens a news website, `bbc.com/news` or any site you like, and prints the **top 5 headlines** to your terminal. You fetch the page with **requests** and pull the headlines out of the HTML with **BeautifulSoup**. The real work is not the code; it is finding out which tag holds a headline on the page you picked.

Tools: Python, requests, BeautifulSoup

2. Requirements

- Keep all your code in a single file named `headlines.py`.
- Fetch the page with `requests` and check the status code before parsing anything.
- Find the headlines yourself by inspecting the page, do not guess the tag.
- Print **exactly 5** headlines, numbered 1 to 5, one per line.
- Strip the whitespace, and skip empty or duplicate entries.
- Send a normal `User-Agent` header; some sites refuse the default Python one.
- Handle the case where fewer than 5 headlines are found instead of crashing.

> **Think it through**
>
> Open the page, right-click a headline and choose Inspect. What tag and class is it in? Try your selector in the browser console first, so you are not debugging blind in Python. And if the page turns out to load its headlines with JavaScript, `requests` will come back with nothing useful: what would you do then?

3. Steps to complete

These are hints, not the full answer. Fill in the blanks yourself.

Step 1: Set up

```
mkdir headlines && cd headlines
python -m venv venv
# macOS / Linux                    # Windows (PowerShell)
source venv/bin/activate           venv\Scripts\Activate.ps1
pip install requests beautifulsoup4
```

Step 2: Write the script

```
import requests
from bs4 import BeautifulSoup

URL = "https://www.bbc.com/news"
headers = {"User-Agent": "Mozilla/5.0"}

page = requests.get(URL, headers=headers, timeout=10)
soup = BeautifulSoup(page.text, "html.parser")

items = soup.find_all(...)          # the tag you found by inspecting
for i, item in enumerate(..., 1):
    print(f"{i}. {item.get_text(strip=True)}")
```

If one selector returns hundreds of matches, you have caught the whole page. Narrow it down until you get headlines and nothing else.

Step 3: Run it

```
python headlines.py
```

4. Final output

```
$ python headlines.py
1. <first headline>
2. <second headline>
3. <third headline>
4. <fourth headline>
5. <fifth headline>
```

5. What to submit

- A screenshot of your terminal showing the 5 headlines printed.
- Your `headlines.py` file, pushed to **GitHub**, with the link shared in **WhatsApp**.
- Your screen-recorded video of the script running, posted in the **community**.